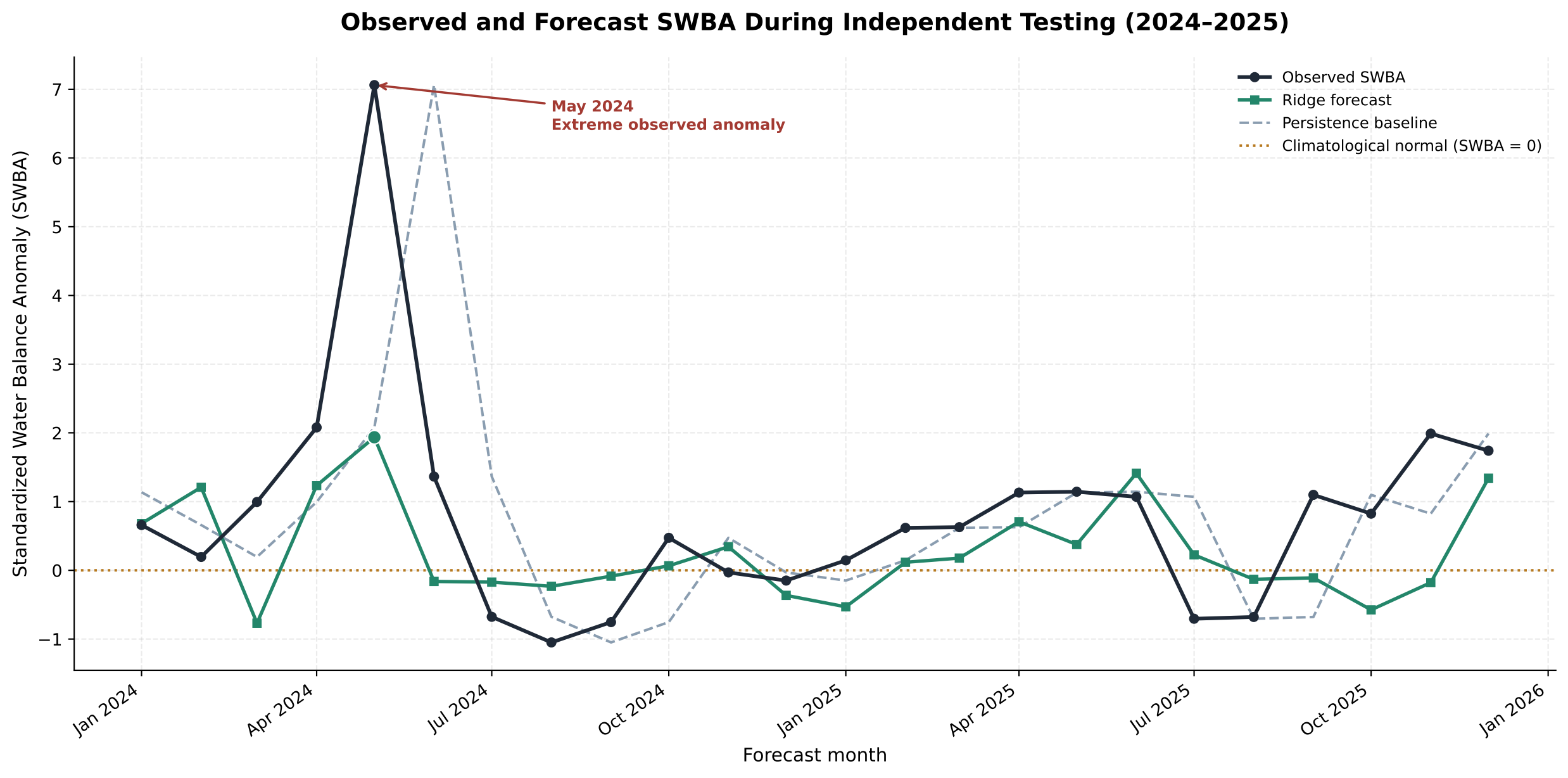
Observed and Forecast SWBA During Independent Testing (2024–2025)
Observed SWBA
Ridge forecast
Persistence baseline
Climatological normal (SWBA = 0)
May 2024
Extreme observed anomaly
Standardized Water Balance Anomaly (SWBA)
7
6
5
4
3
2
1
0
−1
Jan 2024
Apr 2024
Jul 2024
Oct 2024
Jan 2025
Apr 2025
Jul 2025
Oct 2025
Jan 2026
Forecast month